

must be Alexandria can be shown by l. 13; l. 17 gives the date of the text, the time of the marriage festival of Ptolemy VI and Cleopatra II. It is possible that this queen was mentioned in l. 24. P. Harris 61 is of historical importance. It shows how the Ptolemaic government paid extraordinary expenses like those of royal marriages during the difficult period after the death of Ptolemy IV. All Alexandrians who resided in the Egyptian *chora* had, as we learn from the new text, been exempted from the usual¹ register of house-born slaves and from the tax which was perhaps connected with it. On the other hand, the duty of registration and of the payment of a sales-tax on bought slaves² was enforceable on Alexandrians in the same way as on all the other inhabitants of the Egyptian country-side, in spite of evasions which seem to have often occurred. A new royal law of 175/174 B.C. permitted as a privilege, the registration, free of any penalty, of illegally bought slaves in Alexandrian possession, if completed within a fixed period. At the same time the original Alexandrian privilege referring to house-born slaves was cancelled, and such slaves had to be registered too. The people of Alexandria, whose goodwill was important for the weak government of the boy-king Ptolemy VI, was reassured by the promise of the fines expected from the new regulations (not, of course, the additional ordinary revenue). As a sign of gratitude and perhaps under political pressure, the town of Alexandria decreed the donation of a golden statue of Ptolemy VI and a golden crown, as well as sacrifices on the occasion of the 'marriage' festival of the boy-king and his younger sister, which had an important purpose, the strengthening of the dynasty.

F. M. HEICHELHEIM.

A Bushmûric Word

Of the extinct Bushmûric dialect only two words had, it seems, survived:³ ⲱⲛⲱⲩ (*Coptic Dict.*, 528 a) and ⲛⲁⲩⲱ (*ibid.*, 62 a). The former is preserved in the Montpellier *Scala*,⁴ where, with prefixed article ⲙⲁ-, it begins a list entitled ⲁⲩⲙⲁ ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ. It is to Dr. George Sobhy that I owe the completion—obvious indeed to those whose eyes are not holden—of the illegible word. He reads ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ [ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ] and has thus given a valuable key to the mysterious words following the title: *The names of the Cells of (the Monastery of) St. Macarius &c.* These 'dependent cells' must have numbered in all a score and were detached from the main monastery.⁶ The cell most often mentioned elsewhere is that named ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ.⁷ Subtracting the prefixed article (*bi = pi*), we have a word which an easy emendation (ⲱ for ⲱ) allows of identifying with ⲱⲛⲱⲩ, namely ⲱⲛⲱⲩ. The Arabic translation offered by the *Scala*: *فجرة an open spring or source of water*,⁸ refers presumably to a feature of the locality. The presence of a declaredly extraneous word in these Bohairic surroundings raises questions which cannot be discussed here.

The Arabic of the names in our list may mostly be taken to indicate the situations of the cells, though it is doubtful how near they come to translating their Coptic originals: (2) ⲥⲉⲛⲉⲛⲉⲛ *the sunny place, roof-terrace*,⁹ (3) ⲁⲩⲙⲁ ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ *the tree*, perhaps indicating proximity to

¹ Cf. W., *Chr.* No. 199.

² Cf. C. Préaux, *L'Économie Royale des Lagides* (1939), 307 f.

³ Facts and fancies about this dialect may be found in my paper, *Proc. Brit. Acad.* xxv (1939).

⁴ A 17th-century MS. See Mallon, *Méls. Beyrouth* iv, 89, Munier, *Bull. Soc. Arch. Copte* v, 208.

⁵ Space hardly sufficient for this; ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ would suit it better.

⁶ All obtainable facts are collected in H. G. Evelyn White's *History of the Monasteries*, 1932, esp. p. 361.

⁷ Of the variants, *op. cit.* 280, this alone exactly represents the Coptic. Amélineau, *Géogr.* 267, chose the form ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ. No doubt the name is to be read in E. White's pl. xii B as ⲙⲁⲩⲱⲩ, an emasculated form. Cf. my above paper, note 90.

⁸ Exact meaning apparently none too clear. Freytag has *larga pars vallis in qua aqua fluit*.

⁹ See H. Almkvist, *Kleine Beiträge*, ii, 6.

